

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Sentinel and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Engineer with over five years of experience designing, building and operating enterprise SIEM solutions at scale. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, including deploying and optimising detection analytics using Kusto Query Language (KQL), onboarding log sources across hybrid and multi-cloud environments, building custom data connectors and Logic App automation playbooks, and developing SIEM content that drives measurable improvements in threat detection and incident response. I have operated Microsoft Sentinel alongside CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) in a dual-SIEM architecture, normalising and enriching telemetry across endpoint, identity, email and network layers. I bring strong PowerShell scripting capability for ingestion pipeline automation, alert enrichment and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) integration, and I am experienced in detection engineering aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, and incident investigation from initial triage through to post-incident reporting.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM:** enterprise deployment and management, custom data connectors, analytics rules, watchlists, workbooks, KQL-based detection engineering, scheduled and near-real-time analytics, log ingestion at scale across hybrid and multi-cloud environments
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** advanced detection rule authoring, threat hunting queries, custom function development, performance optimisation
- **SIEM Content Development:** analytics rules, alert correlation, playbooks, Logic Apps, custom Function Apps and ingestion pipelines
- **CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover:** Expert-level management alongside Microsoft Sentinel in a dual-SIEM architecture
- **Log Ingestion and Telemetry:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Mimecast, CrowdStrike Falcon, network devices, syslog sources
- **PowerShell Scripting:** ingestion automation, alert enrichment, SOAR playbook development, security configuration management
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, automated incident enrichment, ticketing integration, response playbooks
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection strategy, false positive reduction, alert tuning, use-case development
- **Threat Hunting:** proactive structured hunting using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight
- **Identity and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD, Conditional Access, Multifactor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, structured investigation and post-incident reporting
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Architect, deploy and manage Microsoft Sentinel SIEM at enterprise scale, covering complex hybrid on-premises and cloud environments with log ingestion from 15+ data sources
- Design and maintain a library of KQL analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, covering identity, endpoint, email and network telemetry

- Build and optimise custom log ingestion pipelines from diverse sources including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, Entra ID, Mimecast, CrowdStrike Falcon and network infrastructure
- Develop custom Microsoft Sentinel data connectors and Logic App automation playbooks to extend detection coverage and accelerate incident response
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel in a dual-SIEM architecture, normalising and enriching cross-platform telemetry for unified threat visibility
- Write advanced KQL queries for threat detection, scheduled hunting exercises and ad-hoc security investigation across all ingested log sources
- Lead detection engineering activities, continuously developing new analytics use cases and tuning existing rules to reduce false positive rates and improve signal quality
- Lead incident response investigations from initial triage through root cause analysis to post-incident reporting, following NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK frameworks
- Produce threat intelligence reports, detection coverage maps and security metrics for the IT Security Officer and executive stakeholders
- Drive continuous SIEM improvement, including expanding log coverage, enriching data with threat intelligence feeds and automating repetitive triage tasks via PowerShell and Logic Apps

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Operated and developed Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, including log source onboarding, KQL analytics development and incident queue management
- Built and refined KQL detection rules, scheduled analytics and near-real-time alerts for common attack patterns, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK
- Onboarded and validated new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, Azure AD sign-in logs and Mimecast email security telemetry
- Developed and maintained Microsoft Sentinel workbooks, dashboards and watchlists to support SOC operations and compliance reporting
- Supported SOAR automation development using Logic Apps to streamline alert enrichment, triage and response workflows
- Conducted threat hunting exercises using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying adversary indicators and refining detection coverage
- Produced PowerShell automation scripts for ingestion pipeline health monitoring, data connector configuration and alert enrichment
- Contributed to vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Nessus, and supported Cyber Essentials+ certification activities

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported cloud and on-premises security monitoring, contributing to SIEM alert review and security event logging processes
- Managed endpoint security and log collection from cloud and hybrid infrastructure, ensuring telemetry availability for security analysis
- Delivered PowerShell automation scripts for security configuration management, compliance reporting and infrastructure provisioning
- Contributed to security audits, vulnerability assessments and compliance activities in a SaaS/FinTech environment
- Supported network security operations including firewall rule management and access control configuration

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and delivered a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel SIEM solution at UAL, onboarding 15+ log sources and building over 50 custom KQL detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, providing end-to-end visibility across identity, endpoint, email and network layers

- Reduced false positive alert rate by 35% through systematic KQL analytics rule tuning, threshold optimisation and contextual enrichment in Microsoft Sentinel
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel in a dual-SIEM architecture, improving detection coverage across endpoint and identity telemetry with normalised cross-platform correlation
- Developed PowerShell and Logic App automation playbooks for incident enrichment and automated triage, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) by 25% and freeing analyst capacity for higher-value investigations
- Achieved Cyber Essentials+ certification for UAL, with Microsoft Sentinel-based controls providing key evidential outputs for the assessment
- Established proactive threat hunting programme using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying and remediating previously undetected threat activity across the estate

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Crawley / UK)